

The Department of Defense and its relationship with Legislators

PS 699: Independent Study

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Data

In all, we have 8005 letters received by the DoD marked “congressional” since 2003. All of these are from Members of the U.S. Congress.

```
load(here("data/all_contacts.RData"))  
# one obs per member per letter for all agencies  
d <- all_contacts %>% filter(str_detect(agency, "DOD")) %>% filter(!(last_name == "GRASSLEY"& party == "R"))  
#would Grassley be considered a good outlier??  
# 2007-2017 Data Points
```

Top 10 Legislators who wrote to DoD combined

```
# top overall  
d %>% count(bioname,party,cqlabel, sort = T) %>% top_n(10, n) %>% kable(caption = "Legislators who wrote to DoD")
```

Table 1: Legislators who wrote the most letters to DOD

bioname	party	cqlabel	n
McCAIN, John Sidney, III	(R)	(AZ)	116
FORBES, J. Randy	(R)	(VA-04)	86

bioname	party	cqlabel	n
NELSON, Clarence William (Bill)	(D)	(FL)	84
BURR, Richard M.	(R)	(NC)	75
McCASKILL, Claire	(D)	(MO)	70
TOOMEY, Patrick Joseph	(R)	(PA)	60
WITTMAN, Robert J.	(R)	(VA-01)	60
BOOZMAN, John	(R)	(AR)	59
HUNTER, Duncan Duane	(R)	(CA-50)	59
PELOSI, Nancy	(D)	(CA-08)	59

##FILTER OUT NA??

```
d %>% count(TYPE, sort = T) %>% top_n(10, n) %>% kable(caption = "Most Common Policy Areas")
```

Table 2: Most Common Policy Areas

TYPE	n
1	3779
NA	3326
5	148
6	88
0	43
2	35
3	25
4	3

##Types of Policy each member dealt with

```
d %>% count(bioname, party, TYPE, cqlabel, sort = T) %>% top_n(10, n) %>% kable(caption = "Legislators w
```

Table 3: Legislators who wrote the most letters to DOD

bioname	party	TYPE	cqlabel	n
FORBES, J. Randy	(R)	NA	(VA-04)	58
McCAIN, John Sidney, III	(R)	NA	(AZ)	58
McCASKILL, Claire	(D)	NA	(MO)	52
NELSON, Clarence William (Bill)	(D)	1	(FL)	50
BOOZMAN, John	(R)	1	(AR)	48
McCAIN, John Sidney, III	(R)	1	(AZ)	46
WEBB, James H. (Jim)	(D)	NA	(VA)	45
PELOSI, Nancy	(D)	6	(CA-08)	43
TOOMEY, Patrick Joseph	(R)	1	(PA)	40
BURR, Richard M.	(R)	1	(NC)	38

##COULD ANYTHING BE DONE HERE

most with a given position

```
# d %>% count(bioname, party, cqlabel, letter_position, sort = T) %>% filter(letter_position != "Other")
#
```

```

# # most with a given position in a cycle
# d %>% count(bioname, party, cqlabel, letter_position, congress, sort = T) %>% filter(letter_position
#
# # d %>% filter(str_detect(SUBJECT, "forwards")) %>% add_count(bioname, sort = T) %>% top_n(1, n) %>%
#
# d %>%
# ggplot() +
# aes(x = congress, fill = letter_position) +
# geom_bar(position = "dodge") +
# facet_grid(party_name ~ chamber)

```

###Senators and Veteran Population ###HELP WITH THIS

```

# d %>%
# filter(chamber == "Senate") %>%
# group_by(member_state, year, vetpop2010) %>% summarise(n = n()) %>%
# group_by(member_state, vetpop2010) %>% summarise(mean = mean(n)) %>% ungroup() %>%
# ggplot() +
# geom_point(aes(x = log(vetpop2010), y = mean), color = "light blue") +
# geom_smooth(aes(x = log(vetpop2010), y = mean)) +
# geom_text(aes(x = log(vetpop2010),
#               y = mean,
#               label = ifelse(mean > mean(mean)*1.5 | mean < mean(mean)*0.5,
#                             member_state, "")),
#           check_overlap = TRUE,
#           size = 2.5,
#           hjust = 0) +
# theme_bw() +
# labs(title = "Senator Requests per Year by State Population",
#       x = "Log State Population",
#       y = "Average Number of Requests per Year")

```

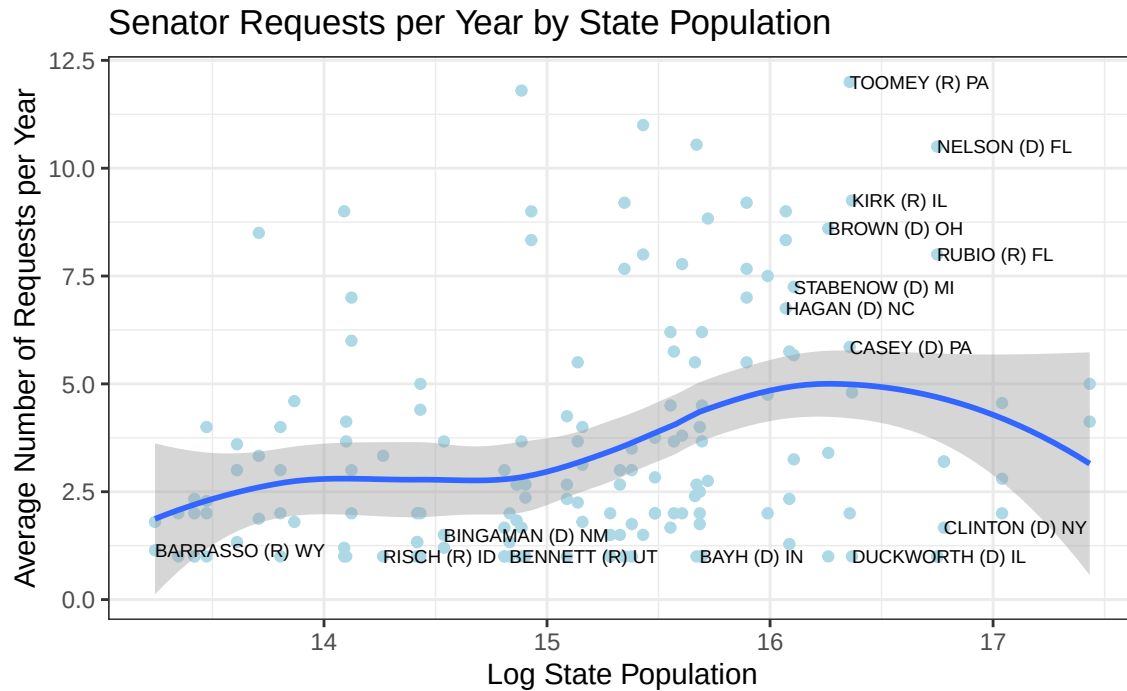
Senators vs. state population

```

d %>%
  filter(chamber == "Senate") %>%
  group_by(member_state, year, pop2010) %>% summarise(n = n()) %>%
  group_by(member_state, pop2010) %>% summarise(mean = mean(n)) %>% ungroup() %>%
  ggplot() +
  geom_point(aes(x = log(pop2010), y = mean), color = "light blue") +
  geom_smooth(aes(x = log(pop2010), y = mean)) +
  geom_text(aes(x = log(pop2010),
                y = mean,
                label = ifelse(mean > mean(mean)*1.5 | mean < mean(mean)*0.5,
                              member_state, "")),
            check_overlap = TRUE,
            size = 2.5,
            hjust = 0) +
  theme_bw() +
  labs(title = "Senator Requests per Year by State Population",
       x = "Log State Population",
       y = "Average Number of Requests per Year")

```

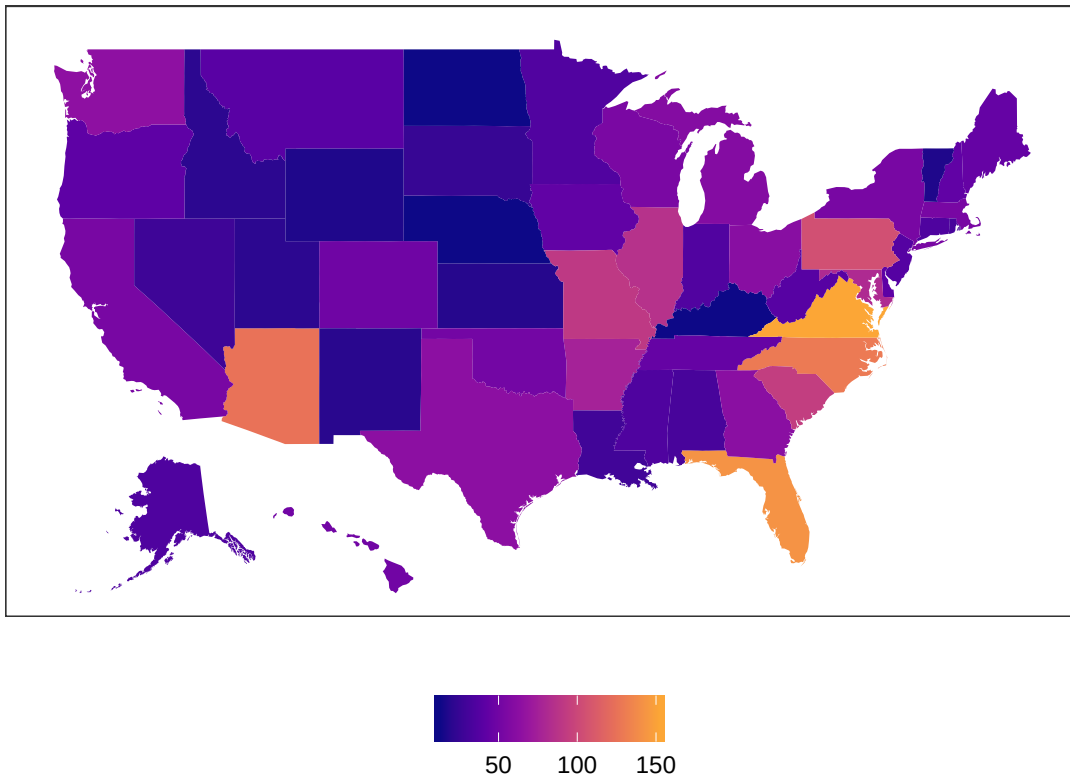
```
## `geom_smooth()` using method = 'loess' and formula 'y ~ x'
```



```
Chamber = "Senate"

d %>%
  ungroup() %>%
  filter(chamber == Chamber) %>%
  group_by(state) %>% summarise(n = n()) %>%
  # map_id creates the aesthetic mapping to the state name column
ggplot() +
  # map points to the fifty_states shape data
  geom_map(aes(map_id = state, fill = n), map = fifty_states) +
  expand_limits(x = fifty_states$long, y = fifty_states$lat) +
  coord_map() +
  scale_x_continuous(breaks = NULL) +
  scale_y_continuous(breaks = NULL) +
  labs(x = "", y = "", title = paste("Total Number of Contacts from members of the", Chamber)) +
  scale_fill_viridis_c(option = "C", end = .8) +
  theme(legend.position = "bottom", legend.title = element_blank(),
        panel.background = element_blank()) # + facet_grid(. ~ Constituent)
```

Total Number of Contacts from members of the Senate



##What on earth is happening here?

```
# d %>%
#   ungroup() %>%
#   filter(chamber == Chamber) %>%
#   group_by(state, pop2010) %>% summarise(n = n()) %>% ungroup() %>%
#   mutate(Per_Capita = n/pop2010*1000000) %>%
#   # map_id creates the aesthetic mapping to the state name column in your data
#   ggplot() +
#   # map points to the fifty_states shape data
#   geom_map(aes(map_id = state, fill = Per_Capita), map = fifty_states) +
#   expand_limits(x = fifty_states$long, y = fifty_states$lat) +
#   coord_map() +
#   scale_x_continuous(breaks = NULL) +
#   scale_y_continuous(breaks = NULL) +
#   labs(x = "", y = "", title = paste("Contacts Per hundred thousand Residents from Members of the", C
#   scale_fill_viridis_c(option = "C", end = .8) +
#   theme(legend.position = "bottom",
#         legend.title = element_blank() )#+facet_grid(. ~ Constituent)

# d %>%
#   mutate(Per_Capita = n/pop2010*1000000) %>% ##FIXME non-numeric argument to binary operator
#   # map_id creates the aesthetic mapping to the state name column in your data
#   ggplot() +
```

```
# # map points to the fifty_states shape data
# geom_map(aes(map_id = state, fill = Per_Capita), map = fifty_states) +
# expand_limits(x = fifty_states$long, y = fifty_states$lat) +
# coord_map() +
# scale_x_continuous(breaks = NULL) +
# scale_y_continuous(breaks = NULL) +
# labs(x = "", y = "", title = paste("Contacts Per hundred thousand Residents from Members of the", C
# scale_fill_viridis_c(option = "C", end = .8) +
# theme(legend.position = "bottom",
#       legend.title = element_blank() )+
# facet_grid(. ~ Constituent)
```

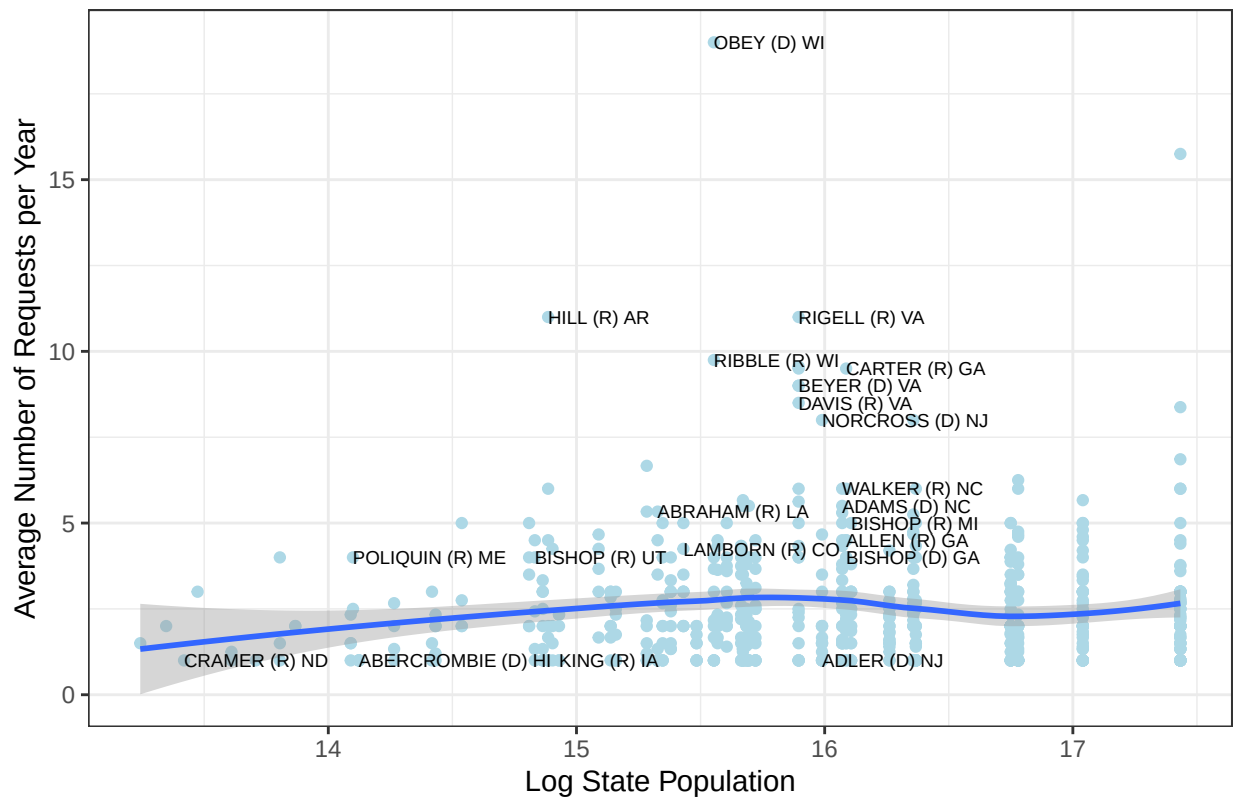
##House Contacts per State

##Would this be relevant??

```
d %>%
  filter(chamber == "House") %>%
  group_by(member_state, year, pop2010) %>% summarise(n = n()) %>%
  group_by(member_state, pop2010) %>% summarise(mean = mean(n)) %>% ungroup() %>%
  ggplot() +
  geom_point(aes(x = log(pop2010), y = mean), color = "light blue") +
  geom_smooth(aes(x = log(pop2010), y = mean)) +
  geom_text(aes(x = log(pop2010),
                y = mean,
                label = ifelse(mean > mean(mean)*1.5 | mean < mean(mean)*0.5,
                              member_state, "")),
            check_overlap = TRUE,
            size = 2.5,
            hjust = 0) +
  theme_bw() +
  labs(title = "House Requests per Year by State Population",
       x = "Log State Population",
       y = "Average Number of Requests per Year")
```

`geom\_smooth()` using method = 'loess' and formula 'y ~ x'

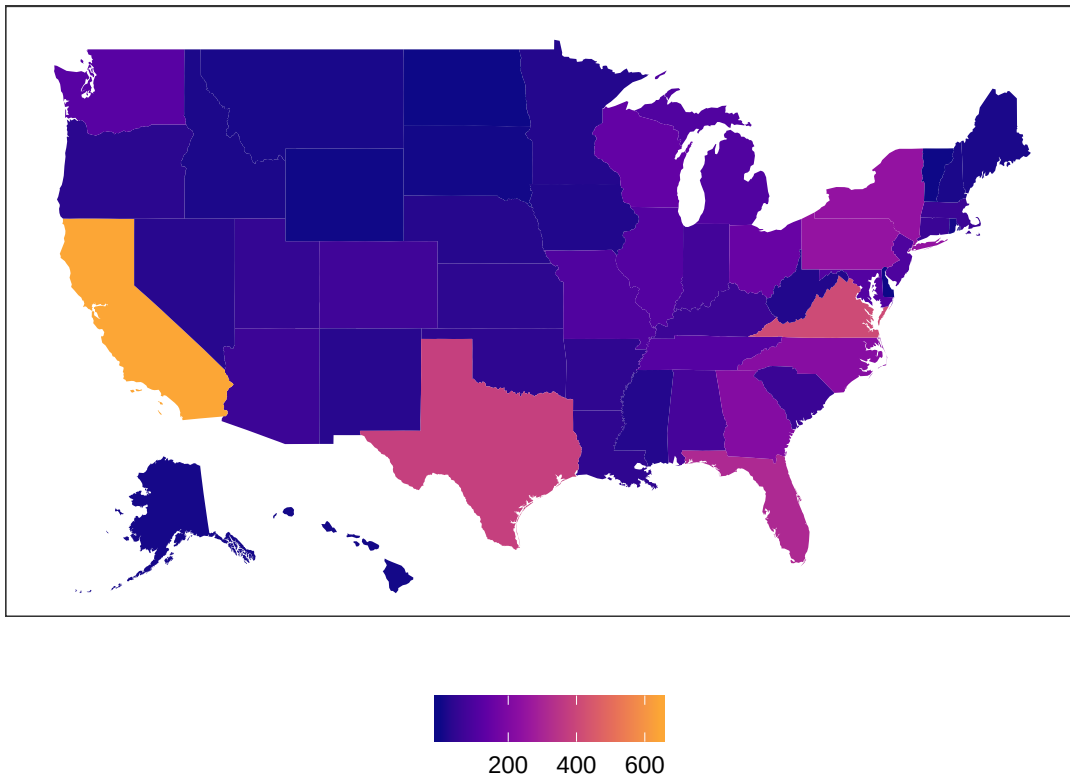
House Requests per Year by State Population



```
Chamber = "House"
```

```
d %>%
  ungroup() %>%
  filter(chamber == Chamber) %>%
  group_by(state) %>% summarise(n = n()) %>%
  # map_id creates the aesthetic mapping to the state name column
  ggplot() +
  # map points to the fifty_states shape data
  geom_map(aes(map_id = state, fill = n), map = fifty_states) +
  expand_limits(x = fifty_states$long, y = fifty_states$lat) +
  coord_map() +
  scale_x_continuous(breaks = NULL) +
  scale_y_continuous(breaks = NULL) +
  labs(x = "", y = "", title = paste("Total Number of Contacts from members of the", Chamber)) +
  scale_fill_viridis_c(option = "C", end = .8) +
  theme(legend.position = "bottom", legend.title = element_blank(),
        panel.background = element_blank()) # + facet_grid(. ~ Constituent)
```

Total Number of Contacts from members of the House



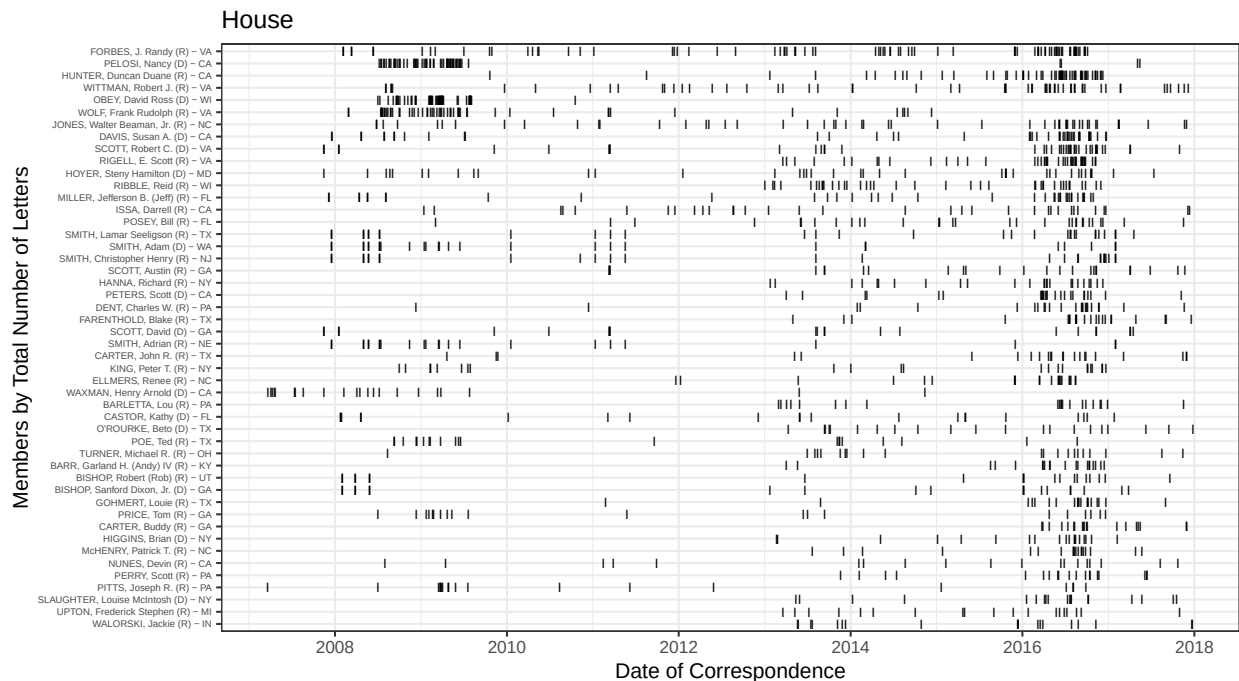
Members who contact DOD more than average:

```
# barcode plot of committee members

# member by year by agency
d %>%
  filter(chamber == Chamber) %>%
  group_by(name_state) %>% mutate(n = n()) %>% ungroup() %>%
  filter(n > mean(n)) %>%
  ggplot() +
  geom_point(
    aes(x = DATE,
        y = reorder(name_state, n) ),
    # alpha = .6,
    shape = 73,
    size=2
  ) +
  labs(title = paste(Chamber),
       y = paste("Members by", "Total Number of Letters"),
       x = "Date of Correspondence" ) +
  theme(
    legend.title = element_blank(),
```

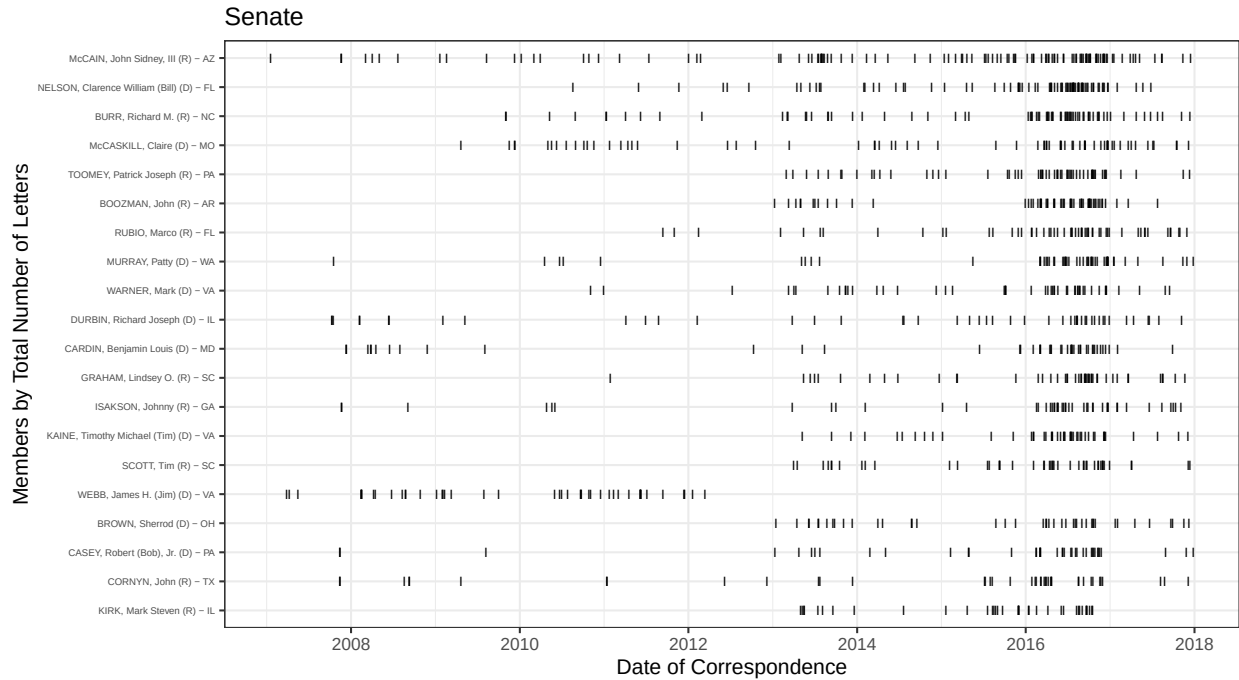


```
axis.text.y = element_text(size=5)
) +
guides(fill=guide_legend(ncol=1))
```



```
Chamber <- "Senate" # "Senate"

# member by year by agency
d %>%
  filter(chamber == Chamber) %>%
  group_by(name_state) %>% mutate(n = n()) %>% ungroup() %>%
  filter(n > mean(n)) %>%
  ggplot() +
  geom_point(
    aes(x = DATE,
        y = reorder(name_state, n) ),
    # alpha = .6,
    shape = 73,
    size=2
  ) +
  labs(title = paste(Chamber),
       y = paste("Members by", "Total Number of Letters"),
       x = "Date of Correspondence" ) +
  theme(
    legend.title = element_blank(),
    axis.text.y = element_text(size=5)
  ) +
  guides(fill=guide_legend(ncol=1))
```



Members who contact DOD more, relative to other agencies:

```
chamber <- "Senate" # "Senate" #why does it say False?
```

```
all_contacts %>%
  filter(chamber == "Senate") %>% #
  mutate(DOD = agency == "DOD") %>%
  group_by(chamber, DOD, name_state, state) %>%
  summarise(n = n() ) %>%
  ungroup() %>%
  #spread(key = "DOD", value = n) %>%
  top_n(10, n) %>%
  knitr::kable()
```

chamber	DOD	name_state	state	n
Senate	FALSE	WARNER, Mark (D) - VA	virginia	2811
Senate	FALSE	SCHUMER, Charles Ellis (Chuck) (D) - NY	new york	5561
Senate	FALSE	NELSON, Clarence William (Bill) (D) - FL	florida	5154
Senate	FALSE	MIKULSKI, Barbara Ann (D) - MD	maryland	3382
Senate	FALSE	McCAIN, John Sidney, III (R) - AZ	arizona	4300
Senate	FALSE	GRASSLEY, Charles Ernest (R) - IA	iowa	3763
Senate	FALSE	GILLIBRAND, Kirsten (D) - NY	new york	3648
Senate	FALSE	FEINSTEIN, Dianne (D) - CA	california	2867
Senate	FALSE	DURBIN, Richard Joseph (D) - IL	illinois	3010
Senate	FALSE	CORNYN, John (R) - TX	texas	3125

```

# mutate(ShareToDOD = round(`TRUE`/(`TRUE`+`FALSE`),2) ) %>%
# arrange(~ShareToDOD) %>%
# mutate(total = `TRUE` + `FALSE`) %>%
# select(name_state, chamber, total, ShareToDOD) %>%
# filter(ShareToDOD>.3) %>%

chamber <- "House"

all_contacts %>%
  filter(chamber == "House") %>% #why is this working this way??
  mutate(DOD = agency == "DOD$") %>%
  group_by(chamber, DOD, name_state, state) %>%
  summarise(n = n() ) %>%
  ungroup() %>%
  #spread(key = "DOD", value = n) %>%
  top_n(10, n) %>%
  knitr::kable()

```

chamber	DOD	name_state	state	n
House	FALSE	WOLF, Frank Rudolph (R) - VA	virginia	2574
House	FALSE	VISCLOSKY, Peter (D) - IN	indiana	1264
House	FALSE	VAN HOLLEN, Christopher (D) - MD	maryland	1303
House	FALSE	THOMPSON, Bennie (D) - MS	mississippi	1373
House	FALSE	SHIMKUS, John M. (R) - IL	illinois	1759
House	FALSE	PALLONE, Frank, Jr. (D) - NJ	new jersey	1149
House	FALSE	McCAUL, Michael T. (R) - TX	texas	1944
House	FALSE	HOYER, Steny Hamilton (D) - MD	maryland	1197
House	FALSE	GOODLATTE, Robert William (R) - VA	virginia	1566
House	FALSE	DENT, Charles W. (R) - PA	pennsylvania	1297

Members who contact FERC more in a Congress, relative to other agencies

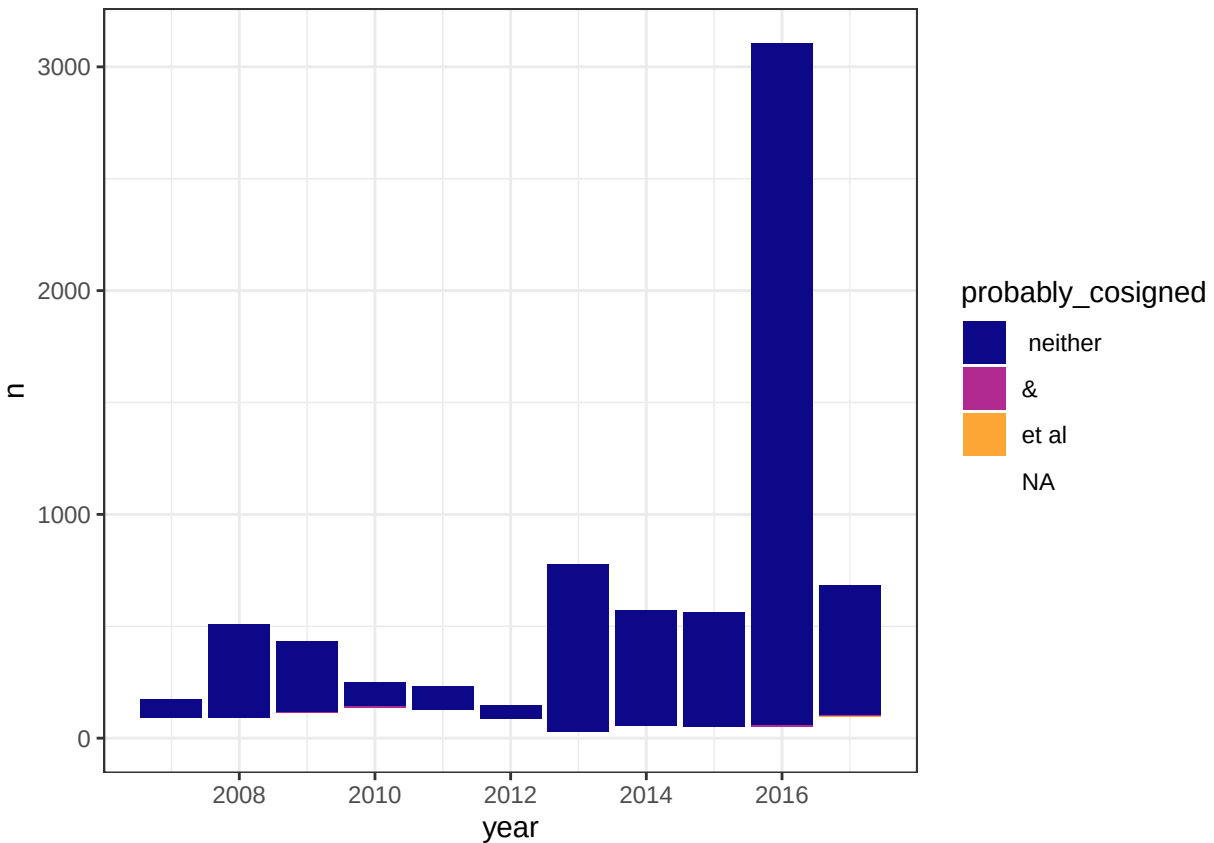
Many letters to DOD are cosigned

#A rough under-estimate based on whether “et al” or “&” appears in the summary: # INVESTIGATE

```

d %>%
  group_by(ID) %>%
  mutate(probably_cosigned = ifelse(str_detect(SUBJECT, "et al"), "et al",
                                     ifelse(str_detect(SUBJECT, "&"), "&", " neither"))) %>%
  group_by(year, probably_cosigned) %>%
  tally %>%
  ggplot() +
  aes(x = year, y = n, fill = probably_cosigned) +
  geom_col() +
  scale_fill_viridis_d(option = "C", end = .8)

```



##How to fix this committee Code

```
# d %>%
# mutate(chair = str_remove(chair, "[0-9]* | ^NA "),
#         committee = paste(chamber, committees))%>%
# dplyr::select(committee, position, chair, DATE, assigneddate, terminationdate) %>%
# distinct() %>%
# filter(str_detect(committee, "ENERGY$|ENVIRONMENT|NATURAL")) %>%
# mutate(position = ifelse(position == "Other", NA, position)) %>%
# #filter(!is.na(position), chair_since_2007 == T) %>%
# drop_na(chair) %>%
# dplyr::select(DATE, chair, position, assigneddate, terminationdate, committee) %>%
# distinct() %>%
# ggplot() +
# geom_point(
#   aes(x = DATE,
#        y = chair),
#   shape = 73,
#   size=2
# ) +
# geom_segment(aes(y = chair, yend = chair,
#                  x = date, xend = date,
#                  linetype = factor(position)),
#              position = position_nudge(y = -0.3)) +
# labs(title = paste("Letters to FERC from Committee Leadership"),
#       y = "",
```

```
#      x = "",
#      linetype = "Leadership position") +
# scale_y_discrete(position = "right") +
# theme(
#   strip.text.y = element_text(angle = 180, size = 5),
#   # legend.title = element_blank(),
#   axis.text.y = element_text(size=5),
#   axis.text.x = element_text(angle = 0)
# ) +
# facet_grid(committee ~ ., scales = "free_y", space = "free_y", switch = "both")
```

Limitations

Throughout the course of this independent study, there were a few challenges and limitations I faced.

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FERC Paper

US Veteran Census

#Notes:

1. Count letters by member by year (including zero counts)
2. Policy Stuff
3. Divide by years--annualized by years
4. Control with Gender--how long they're in congress
5. Veterans--More likely to write, shared Veteran status. Veterans-gender-bias
6. What Kind of Variate Models??